

WALT

Walt Viviers

Creative Director / Art Director / Digital Marketer / Fine Artist

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PROFILE

Creative Director and digital marketing strategist with 20 years of progressive experience — from Junior Designer to Creative Director at a leading South African digital agency. Hands-on design craft (brand identity, motion graphics, UI/UX, print, digital) paired with strategic leadership and the RMFA Method: Research, Marketing Funnel, Analytics — turning creative output into measurable business results. Proven track record delivering exceptional ROI for major brands, including 4,343% for Kaizer Chiefs and 944% for Alpha Industries. Co-founded and successfully exited a profitable printing business. MEA Business Award winner. Practising fine artist. Early AI tools adopter.

KEY RESULTS · 2024

- Kaizer Chiefs — 4,343% ROI: Full website UX/UI/SEO overhaul + Shopify e-commerce + Google Ads.
- Alpha Industries — 944% ROI: E-commerce UX/UI/SEO + Google Ads.
- Sebago — 822.5% ROI: E-commerce UX/UI/SEO + Google Ads sales campaigns.
- Superga — 552.34% ROI: E-commerce strategy + Google Ads. 3,558 conversions. 7.5M+ campaign impressions.
- Kappa — 362.5% ROI: E-commerce + Google Ads sales funnel.

EXPERIENCE

Creative Director · Menzies Media

Nov 2019 – Present

Full-time · Johannesburg, Gauteng

- Spearhead the creative vision across all digital marketing projects — from concept to launch — for a portfolio of major SA and international brands.
- Deliver formal presentations and pitch creative concepts to potential clients; establish conceptual and stylistic direction for all design staff.
- Orchestrate the work of designers, copywriters, production artists, photographers, illustrators, and printers across all active projects.
- Manage and evaluate creative staff; ensure all projects meet the design brief, are delivered on time, and within budget.
- Oversee UX/UI direction (Figma), e-commerce build-outs (Shopify), Google Ads strategy, and the look, feel, and navigation of all client websites.
- Integrate AI-powered tools (ChatGPT, Gemini, Deepseek) into team creative workflows for concepting, production, and delivery.
- Clients: Kaizer Chiefs, Alpha Industries, Kappa, Sebago, Superga, Broll Property Group, Eris Property Group, SAB, Mochachos, PrintingSA, Villas in Cape Town, Oaksure, 1.618 Group.

Art Director · Menzies Media

Jul 2016 – Oct 2019

Full-time · 3 yrs 4 mos · Johannesburg, Gauteng

- Set the overall visual tone and timbre for all creative work — from colour palettes and photo shoot direction to the graphic values of websites and campaigns.
- Established conceptual and stylistic direction for design staff; participated in pitches and formal presentations to prospective clients.
- Art directed photography shoots: defined acquisition themes, styling, and visual language aligned with each brand identity.
- Developed motion-based content (After Effects, animated GIFs, video) for social media, digital campaigns, and ATL activations.
- Mentored junior designers; maintained creative quality and brand consistency across all touchpoints.

Senior Graphic Designer · Menzies Media

Jul 2012 – Jun 2016

Full-time · 4 yrs · Johannesburg, Gauteng

- Took design briefs and implemented them end-to-end — viewing each project not in isolation, but as part of the client's bigger marketing picture.
- Delivered design solutions from concept to completion: rough sketches, comps, layouts, and final art, working exclusively within Adobe Creative Suite.
- Utilised photography and illustration alongside digital design to achieve the precise visual results required by each brief.
- Collaborated closely with copywriters, photographers, and sales staff on integrated campaigns across print, digital, and social.
- Built and maintained brand systems for multiple client accounts simultaneously.

Graphic Designer · Co-Founder · Bang Bang Advertising

Feb 2007 – Feb 2010

Full-time · 3 yrs · Johannesburg, Gauteng

- Identified a market opportunity and co-founded a printing brokerage from the ground up.
- Built the company's operational framework, business strategy, and creative output.
- Grew the business to profitability, then successfully sold my share — a clean exit from a thriving venture.

Web Designer / Illustrator · 1985.co.za

Jan 2010 – Jul 2012

Freelance · 2 yrs 7 mos · Roodepoort, Gauteng

- Delivered web design, graphic design, and illustration projects for clients across various industries.
- Built and maintained websites; produced print collateral, digital assets, and illustrative work.

Senior Designer · Solutions Advertising

Jun 2011 – Jun 2012

Full-time · 1 yr 1 mo · Johannesburg, Gauteng

- Owned visual communication strategy; created versatile design concepts across print and digital channels.

Graphic Designer · Pro GraphicsMar

2010 – May 2011

Full-time · Randburg, Gauteng

- Translated project requirements into high-quality layouts for marketing collateral, corporate documents, and print media.

Junior Designer · GY Print

Jan 2006 – Jan 2007

Full-time · Johannesburg, Gauteng

- Handled layout and production design for diverse marketing applications; ensured visual consistency and print-ready output.

Graphic & Audio/Visual Designer · Sweat Shop Productions

2006

Freelance / Self-Employed · Johannesburg, Gauteng

- Operated under own multimedia entity — writing, directing, editing, photography, poster design, DVD covers, storyboards, and multimedia design.
- Produced diverse visual and audio/visual content across various media formats for independent clients.

Graphic Designer · Stenele Bosch Africa

2006

Freelance · Architectural Practice · Johannesburg, Gauteng

- Commissioned to produce an artistic impression of the Ivory Park Bridges — architectural visualisation and graphic design for a civil engineering project.

Graphic Designer · T.H.E (The Human Effect)

2005

Freelance · Music Industry

- Conceptualisation and design of CD sleeve for the band T.H.E (The Human Effect) — cover art, typography, and print layout.

Production Assistant · Pierre Smith Music Video

Dec 2005

Short-term Contract · Johannesburg, Gauteng

- On-set production assistant to director Pierre Smith — responsibilities included diving, cable bashing, and general set assistance.

Waiter · Maloney's Restaurant

Aug 2005 – Dec 2005

Part-time whilst studying at AFDA · Johannesburg, Gauteng

- Front-of-house service in a busy restaurant environment; developed strong customer service and interpersonal skills alongside studies.

Salesperson / Teller · Look & Listen

Jan 2005 – Jul 2005

Part-time whilst studying at AFDA · Clearwater, Gauteng

- Sales floor and till operations at a major retail entertainment store; completed formal Look & Listen Customer Service Training Program.

Graphic Designer · Tattoo Millennium

2004

Freelance / Holiday Employment · Johannesburg, Gauteng

- School holiday freelance — conceptualisation and design of logos, advertising, pamphlets, letterheads, and business cards for the tattoo studio and its clients. While doing my piercing and tattoo apprenticeship.

Graphic / Multimedia Designer · S.A.i.N

2004

Freelance · Marketing Industry · Johannesburg, Gauteng

- Designed logo and letterheads; conceptualised and built the company website at sain.co.za — full visual identity and digital presence from scratch.

Graphic Designer · Umdlalo Wami

2003

Freelance · Psychology Practice · Johannesburg, Gauteng

- Designed full visual identity for a psychology practice — logo, letterheads, and business cards; conceptualisation through to print-ready artwork.

Fine Artist · Freelance Designer · waltviviers.com

2010 – Present

Freelance · Pretoria, Gauteng

- Practising fine artist — acrylic & mixed media, illustration — represented on Saatchi Art; shown on Behance, Instagram, and Dribbble.
- Freelance web design, graphic design, and illustration; AI-assisted design and web workflows.

SKILLS & TOOLS

Creative Creative Direction · Art Direction · Brand Identity · Visual Design · Motion Graphics · Animation · Typography · Colour Theory · Print Production · Campaign Concepting

Digital Marketing E-Commerce (Shopify) · Google Ads · SEO/SEM · Google Analytics · Meta Business Suite · SE Ranking · Search Console · Tag Manager · Merchant Center

Design Software Adobe Creative Suite (Photoshop · Illustrator · InDesign · After Effects · Premiere Pro) · Figma · Canva Pro

Web & Tech WordPress · UI/UX Design · HTML/CSS · Google Workspace · GitHub · AI tools (ChatGPT · Gemini · Deepseek · Claude)

Languages English (fluent) · Afrikaans (fluent)

AWARDS

- Leading Pioneers in Digital Marketing — MEA Business Awards, January 2021
- Best Next-Gen Tech-Driven Marketing Company, Southern Africa — MEA Business Awards, January 2020
- Best Art / Design Student Floating Trophy — Design School S.A., January 2004

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

1st Year BA — Motion Picture: Animation, Directing & Writing · AFDA

2005

African Film and Drama Academy — South Africa's leading School of Motion Picture Medium and Live Performance. Majors: Animation (distinction) · Directing (distinction) · Writing (distinction).

Film assists: The Karmic Obligation · Five Minutes. Role: First Assistant Director — Storyboarding, Shoot Scheduling, Smooth Running of Operations.

Senior Certificate · Hoërskool Florida

2000 – 2004

Subjects: Art (distinction) · Design (distinction) · English · Afrikaans · Biology · Computer Science. Awarded The Design School S.A. Best Art/Design Student Floating Trophy 2004/5. Certificate of Merit for Art & Design.

Google / Coursera

From Likes to Leads: Interact with Customers Online *Google/Coursera, Aug 2025 ↗*

Attract and Engage Customers with Digital Marketing *Google/Coursera, Jul 2025 ↗*

Foundations of Digital Marketing and E-commerce *Google/Coursera, Jul 2025 ↗*

Programming Hub

Digital Marketing Advanced *Programming Hub, Jan 2024* ↗

Digital Marketing *Programming Hub, Dec 2023* ↗

Material Design *Programming Hub, Dec 2023* ↗

Digital Skills: User Experience *Accenture / FutureLearn, Jul 2021* ↗

CSS Fundamentals *Sololearn, Jul 2019* ↗

HTML Fundamentals *Sololearn, Mar 2019* ↗

Early Courses

Customer Service Training Program *Look & Listen, 2005*

Sales and Marketing *Creative Council, 2005*

REFERENCES

Humphrey Mukwenga *Lead Web Developer, LSi*

"Walt is a visionary in the field of design, particularly excelling in UI/UX... What sets Walt apart is his unique blend of creativity and practicality. He not only has an eye for stunning design but also a deep understanding of the technical aspects of development."

Kieran Pearce *Head of Digital, Waypoint Digital*

"Walt is an incredible creative, really has always gone above and beyond. His brain is really unique, and it shows in the work he produces."

Neal Strydom *Motion Designer*

"Walt is an inspirational, down-to-earth and logical voice within the chaotic realms of creativity. I am confident that with Walt's creative and art direction, the work being produced will be of stellar quality."

Maxime de Montbron *Cyber Security Analyst (fmr. Junior Data Scientist, Menzies Media)*

"Walt maintained the highest degree of professionalism when it came to managing his staff. His combination of creativity, intellectual ability, and people skills makes him an invaluable asset to any company."

Leigh Munro *Graphic Designer, Paragon Banking Group PLC*

"Walt has expertise in many fields, including design, UX, animation and creative direction. He is incredibly creative and can produce high-quality concepts and designs under pressure."

Full references at [linkedin.com/in/waltviviers](https://www.linkedin.com/in/waltviviers)